

M'chalkel

74a

Version 2

Max Wohlberg
Arr. Stuart Izon

The second blessing of the Amida describes God's ability to subvert the natural order, culminating in the resurrection of the dead.

One of the most famous settings of M'chalkel is by Max Wohlberg. The manner in which it is commonly sung today differs from his original melody as printed in Shirei Zimrah in a number of ways: inclusions of filler notes, and the omission of the augmented 4th on the word umatir, which implies a secondary dominant chord, as you can find in this arrangement. A nice little piece of word painting is in the descending line for lisheinei afar, "those who sleep in the dust". Though Wohlberg's composition finishes here, many congregations repeat the same melody for the following line, and the effect of the descending theme over "umatzmiach y'shua" is rendered meaningless.

Wohlberg wrote M'chalkel specifically for junior congregations, and stated in private conversation that he composed it purely as a device for teaching the prayer to children. He later wrote other melodies for M'chalkel which he considered more appropriate for adults. Nevertheless this has become so popular that it has come to be regarded as the standard nusach in America.

Allegro

Melody Alto
8
M'-chal - kel cha - yim b' - che - sed m'-cha - yei mei - tim b' -

Tenor Bass
8
-ra-cha-mim ra-bim so-meich no - f' - lim v' - ro - fei cho - lim u - ma - tir a - su -

5
M
A
8
-rim um ka - yeim e - mu - na - to li - shei - nei a - far

T
B
8
-rim um ka - yeim e - mu - na - to li - shei - nei a - far